

# KOK Kitchens

## Delivery Options Comparison

Evaluating third-party delivery providers for KOK Kitchens in Hertfordshire

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### Overview

This document compares the main delivery API options available for integrating third-party courier services into the KOK Kitchens website. All options are “white-label” — customers order on your website and a courier picks up and delivers. Your brand stays front and centre.

### Side-by-Side Comparison

| Feature                | Uber Direct<br><b>RECOMMENDED</b>                                                                        | Stuart (DPD Group)<br><b>ORIGINAL</b>                                                     | Gophr                                                              |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What it is             | Uber’s white-label delivery API — uses Uber’s driver network without Uber Eats branding                  | On-demand courier platform backed by DPD Group                                            | UK-based same-day courier platform, eco-focused                    |
| Cost per delivery      | £3.50 – £6.50 (distance-based)                                                                           | £5 – £9 (distance-based)                                                                  | £5 – £8 (distance-based)                                           |
| Monthly / setup fees   | None — pay per delivery only                                                                             | None — pay per delivery only                                                              | None — pay per delivery only                                       |
| Courier fleet size     | <b>Very large</b> — UK-wide, strongest suburban coverage                                                 | Medium — concentrated in major cities                                                     | Small — primarily London and South East                            |
| Hertfordshire coverage | <b>Good</b> — strong driver availability in suburbs including Borehamwood, Watford, Radlett, Potters Bar | <b>Limited</b> — fewer riders outside London; availability may be patchy in Herts suburbs | <b>Uncertain</b> — London-centric; may not cover all KOK postcodes |

|                             |                                                                           |                                                |                                   |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>Avg delivery time</b>    | 15 – 35 mins                                                              | 20 – 40 mins                                   | 20 – 40 mins                      |
| <b>Real-time tracking</b>   | Yes — live map link for customers                                         | Yes — tracking URL provided                    | Yes — tracking link               |
| <b>Proof of delivery</b>    | Yes — photo + signature options                                           | Yes — built-in                                 | Yes                               |
| <b>Surge / peak pricing</b> | Yes — prices increase during peak demand (lunch/dinner rush, bad weather) | Minimal — pricing more stable                  | No surge pricing                  |
| <b>API quality</b>          | REST API, well-documented, webhooks for status updates                    | REST API, clean documentation, webhook support | REST API, decent docs             |
| <b>Scheduled deliveries</b> | Yes                                                                       | Yes — strong scheduling features               | Yes                               |
| <b>Customer ratings</b>     | Trustpilot: 3.5/5 (mixed — includes Uber Eats reviews)                    | Trustpilot: 3.8/5                              | Trustpilot: 4.2/5 (highest rated) |
| <b>Brand experience</b>     | White-label — no Uber branding to customers                               | White-label — courier arrives unbranded        | White-label                       |
| <b>Integration effort</b>   | ~1 day development                                                        | ~1 day development                             | ~1 day development                |

## Pros and Cons Summary

### Uber Direct

**RECOMMENDED**

| Pros                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Cons                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Largest courier fleet in the UK</li> <li>• Best suburban coverage — critical for Hertfordshire</li> <li>• Lower cost per delivery (£3.50–£6.50)</li> <li>• Real-time tracking with white-label link</li> <li>• No monthly fees, pay per delivery</li> <li>• Customers trust the Uber logistics network</li> <li>• Well-documented REST API with webhooks</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Surge pricing at peak times can increase costs</li> <li>• Less control over individual courier quality</li> <li>• Trustpilot reviews are mixed (3.5/5)</li> <li>• Requires business onboarding process</li> </ul> |

### Stuart (DPD Group)

**ORIGINALLY CHOSEN**

| Pros                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Cons                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Backed by DPD Group — reliable brand</li> <li>• Clean REST API with webhook support</li> <li>• Good for scheduled deliveries</li> <li>• Proof of delivery built in</li> <li>• More stable pricing (less surge)</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• More expensive per delivery (£5–£9)</li> <li>• Smaller fleet — longer wait times outside London</li> <li>• Hertfordshire coverage may be limited</li> <li>• Less brand recognition to end customers</li> </ul> |

### Gophr

| Pros                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Cons                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Highest merchant ratings (Trustpilot 4.2/5)</li> <li>• UK company with local support</li> <li>• Eco-friendly bike couriers</li> <li>• Food-delivery focused API</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Primarily London-centric coverage</li> <li>• Hertfordshire coverage uncertain</li> <li>• Smallest fleet of the three options</li> <li>• May not service all KOK delivery postcodes</li> </ul> |

## Self-Delivery Option (Current Setup)

KOK Kitchens currently uses self-delivery with flat fees:

- **£4.99** for local postcodes (WD6, WD7, WD23, WD25, EN5, EN6)
- **£7.99** for extended postcodes (wider Hertfordshire, NW London, Barnet)

| Pros                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Cons                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Full control over customer experience</li> <li>• No per-delivery API cost</li> <li>• Personal touch builds customer loyalty</li> <li>• Already working today</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Doesn't scale with order volume</li> <li>• No real-time tracking for customers</li> <li>• Tied to personal availability</li> <li>• Limits maximum delivery radius</li> </ul> |

**Recommendation:** A **hybrid model** works best for KOK Kitchens — continue self-delivering to nearby local postcodes (WD6, WD7, EN5, EN6) for the personal touch, and use Uber Direct for extended-zone deliveries where you need driver availability and tracking. This keeps costs low locally and scales for busier periods or further deliveries.

## Cost Comparison Example

Based on a typical delivery within 5 miles:

| Provider      | Your cost  | Customer pays | Your margin |
|---------------|------------|---------------|-------------|
| Uber Direct   | £4.50      | £4.99         | £0.49       |
| Stuart        | £6.50      | £7.99         | £1.49       |
| Gophr         | £5.50      | £7.99         | £2.49       |
| Self-delivery | ~£2 (fuel) | £4.99         | ~£2.99      |

*Note: Uber Direct costs shown are estimates at standard rates. Actual costs vary by distance and time of day. Surge pricing may apply during peak hours.*

**Questions?** Reach out to Samuel on WhatsApp or email at [samlawal@hotmail.com](mailto:samlawal@hotmail.com).